



Dear Valued Customer –

During my tenure, we conducted a “Listening & Learning” tour that informed the Connect team that security, personalized services, and strong fiscal support are essential to supporting today’s schools. Here are some highlights:

Security & Technology Improvements

- Install new cybersecurity platform that detects threats 24/7
- Manage risk with new “Next Generation Firewall” that uses an intrusion detection system
- Partner with MCOECN server hosting that includes a backup hot site
- Ensure data integrity with more responsive and reliable backup system
- Network moving to a dedicated network security building that includes:
 - Redundant power sources, generators and climate control systems
 - 24/7 security and required credentialing upon entering
 - Oarnet point of presence is within 100 feet of equipment
 - Company equipment stored in a secured cage
- Consult with experts to institute new Disaster Recovery and security policies
- Document NIST standards practices in Apptega Software system
- Integrate Liquid Files, a secure email and file transfer solution
- Expand technology services, such as: server hosting, phone systems, district backup services etc
- Collaborate with CISCO/Meraki partner
- Provide low cost purchase of end-user devices for school districts

Other Improvements

- District payroll services support available
- PowerSchool team expanded from 2.5 to 3.6 FTE
- EMIS support doubled from three to six staff members
- Tyler Munis support is a team approach

6393 Oak Tree Boulevard, Suite 105 | Independence, Ohio 44131 | P: 216.520.6900 | F:216.520.6969

1885 Lake Avenue | Elyria, Ohio 44035 | P: 440.324.3185 | F: 440.324.6140

www.ohconnect.org



- Launch a payroll academy aligned to national credentialing
- Implement a treasurers' network in collaboration with NCCS
- Add Infinite Campus student information system as a choice for districts
- Expand hybrid and in-person training events
- Increase access to events, services, and documentation via new website
- New Executive Director is an award-winning Treasurer

We are proud that we have improved our services to our schools, but to continue these services and to grow our fiscal and PowerSchool staff we respectfully request your investment in these shared support services. We thank you for your commitment to Connect while maintaining the lowest fee structure in the state of Ohio, but we are unable to do more with less. In 2011, our fee for core services was \$18.50 and then during the merger fees were reduced to demonstrate our commitment to the best services at the lowest price. Unfortunately, with today's exponential cybersecurity needs, we require a fee increase that is more aligned with our 2011 fee in order to better serve your schools.

With the exception of the infrastructure fee, schools that are currently mid-contract will not be subject to the increases below until the contract comes up for renewal, at which point they will be brought on to the current Fiscal Year fee schedule. We thank you in advance for your support.

Fee	23-24 per ADM increase
Core (Fiscal, EMIS, Student)	\$1.00
Library	\$0.25 to \$3.25
DataSecurity	\$-0.75 to \$1.00
Max Total	\$5.25
<i>One time 2023-2024 infrastructure fee</i>	\$11.50

6393 Oak Tree Boulevard, Suite 105 | Independence, Ohio 44131 | P: 216.520.6900 | F:216.520.6969

1885 Lake Avenue | Elyria, Ohio 44035 | P: 440.324.3185 | F: 440.324.6140

www.ohconnect.org



Business/Administrative Items Related to Contracts and Fees

1. **Service Agreement:** Districts/Schools that are due new contracts will receive both a 1-year and 3-year Service Agreement.
 - The *Term* for the 3-year Service Agreement affords the district/school the opportunity to lock-in Core Services *Support* fees at no increase for the duration of the contract.
 - **Please review, sign, and return the agreement of your choice to connect-services@ohconnect.org by May 19, 2023.**
2. **District-Specific Exhibit A:** Districts/Schools that are due new contracts will receive an Exhibit, which includes those services to which your district/school subscribes.
 - If there will be any changes to the services selected on the Exhibit, please let us know as soon as possible, even if you are unable to return the signed copy until after it is approved by your board. This will allow us to plan ahead and reach out to vendors if any changes are forthcoming. **CONNECT must be made aware of any changes to current subscriptions as soon as possible, but by no later than May 12.**
 - **Please review, sign, and return the exhibit to connect-services@ohconnect.org by May 19, 2023.**
3. **Fee Schedule:** Districts/Schools that are *not* due new contracts will receive a 2023-2024 Fee Schedule for budgeting purposes.
4. **Quotes:** For certain services (such as Internet Content Filtering, Zoom products, and more), Connect will send a quote which must be signed in order to renew for 2023-2024 (even if that item is 'marked' on the Exhibit A for your district/school).
5. **Discontinuing a Service:** For any of the services (support, software, subscriptions, et al) listed on the Exhibit A or Fee Schedule, should the school/district wish to discontinue a service, notice must be provided in writing 90 days prior to the renewal date for that service. If no notice is received, it will be assumed that the service should renew for the following school year.
6. **Pricing:**
 - **Core Services Support fees** - For those schools that signed 3-year contracts that began July 1, 2022, the Core Services Support fees are locked for the duration of the contract.
 - 2023-2024 pricing has not yet been confirmed by some vendors; that has been indicated in the comments column where appropriate.



- **Data Security Fee** - The pricing structure has been updated for FY24 to be more equitable based upon the number of services received by the customer. It applies to customers receiving support for one or more core services. The fee depends upon the number of core services received. *e.g: If a school receives all core services, the fee would be \$2.50/student. If a school receives only student and library services, the fee would be \$1.25 + \$0.75 = \$2.00/student.*
 - \$2.50 – all Core Services received (maximum charge)
 - OR -
 - \$1.25 – Student Services received
 - \$1.25 – Fiscal Services received
 - \$0.75 - Library Services received
- **Infrastructure Fee** - One-time fee for public schools receiving the full Core Service Suite
- **INFOhio/Library Support:** This fee was previously included in the Core Services Suite, but has been set apart into a separate item.
- **CrossCheck:** This fee had been waived for schools receiving EMIS & Student Services for 2022-2023. For 2023-2024, a fee will be charged to cover licensing/support costs.

Should you have any questions on the attached, please do not hesitate to reach out to connect-services@ohconnect.org.

Thank you!